

2020 MICRO PROJECTS

Monitoring and Evaluation Report

Report by Hope Center - Syria 2021

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“And let us consider how we may spur one another on toward love and good deeds”

Hebrews 10:24

In a country destroyed by all kinds of wars experienced by mankind, such as our country **Syria**.
Man has become a forgotten mass of pain and need... the Syrian family became a model of shattering and destruction and a living example which bears witness to the injustice of humanity. In this dark reality, many Syrians left their beloved country, but also many Syrians with a bright heart stayed... a light and a candle of change, even for short-term, but it seeks to continue despite the daily winds of despair. From the heart of pain and the hope of salvation.

The **Hope Center** set off with a candle of hope lit from the Words of Jesus:
“I am the light of the world. Whoever follows me will not walk in darkness, but will have the light of life.”



1.

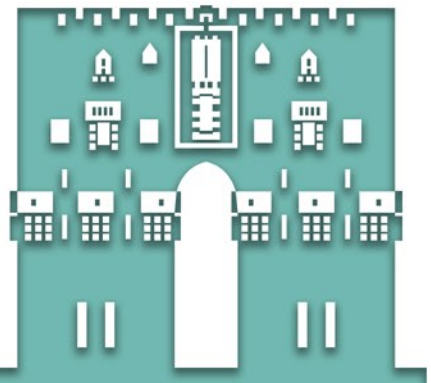
ALEPPO



349
Funded Projects

1270
Individuals helped from Beneficiaries' families

83%
Reviving their lost job



The Micro Projects program aims to help and serve the Christian families affected by the war in Syria, by supporting them to revive their work or start a new job opportunity to secure a stable income and cover their basic needs, in addition to rebuilding the economic structure of the community on a micro level.

This program is about giving a loan to buy the required equipment and requirements such as the initial materials to start the project, with a refund rate of 20-30 percent of the total loan amount, so that the beneficiary becomes a partner with the objectives of the center to finance additional projects.

What distinguishes our center in supporting micro projects is that we continue to follow the beneficiary through all stages of his project after financing in periodic monitoring visits to the workplace to follow-up all the details of the project.

Since the launch of the Micro Projects Program in 2018,
349 projects have been funded in the city of Aleppo till the end of the year 2020.

2. Our Work:

2.1 projects according to their work fields:

- **Taxi**
- **Shops:** shoes - clothes - mobiles - stationery- supermarket - hardware - car parts – electrical equipment
- **Services:** Gym-network gaming
- **Other Vehicles:** mini pickup trucks - van
- **Music:** Musical instruments and sound systems
- **Medical:** Medical services (nursing kits- physical therapy devices- dental laboratory)
- **Media:** cameras – designing tools
- **Food:** pastries-sandwiches
- **Crafts:** Industrial crafts (carpentry - blacksmith – Aluminum crafting - lathing - paint - maintenance of refrigerators and washing machines - mobiles and computers maintenance- laser cutting- metal molding)
- **Clothes:** Sewing and manufacturing clothing
- **Car Crafts:** Car repairs and equip
- **Beauty:** Women's and Men's hairdressing - Makeup kits
- **Artistic Crafts:** handmade sculpturing and drawing

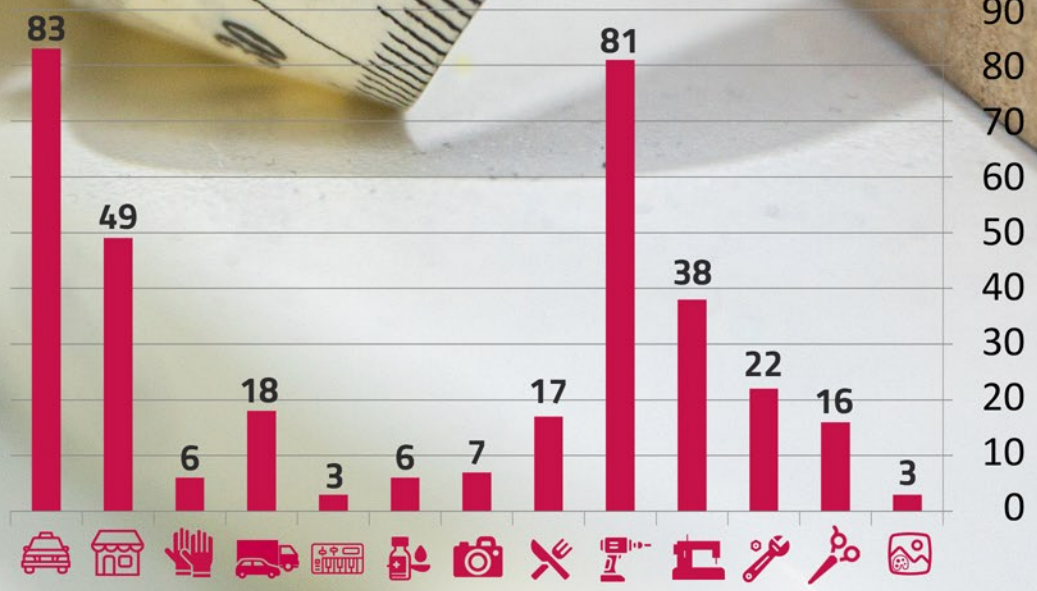


Figure 1

We note from Figure1 that the categories of crafts and vehicles create **55%** of all projects for the following reasons:



Taxi projects:

- The number of applicants for taxi projects was **302** out of **1,411** projects, or **21%** of applicants.
- Supporting newly discharged soldiers with car projects because they do not require as much experience as other projects
- The desire of some applicants for the taxi projects due to the loss of their basic work, which requires a large capital to start again.

Craft projects:

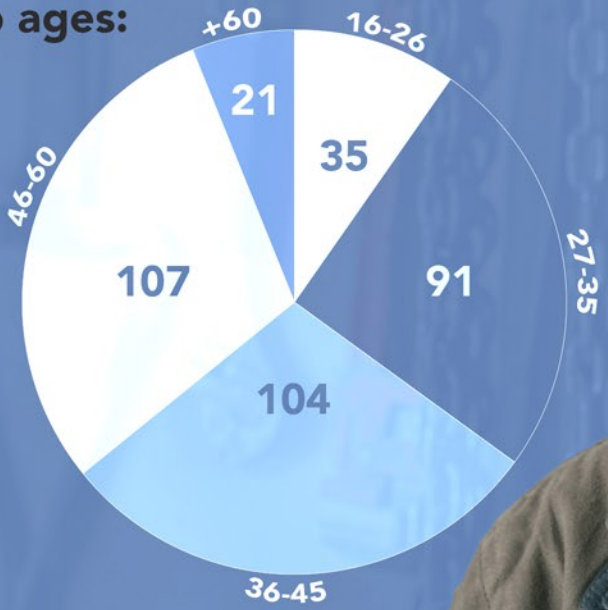
- Aleppo is one of the most important industrial provinces in Syria.
- Of the **1,411** projects, **245** are applicants for craft projects, or **17%** of applicants.
- The return of to some industrial areas in Aleppo to safety.

The following chart show
the categories of crafts in details:



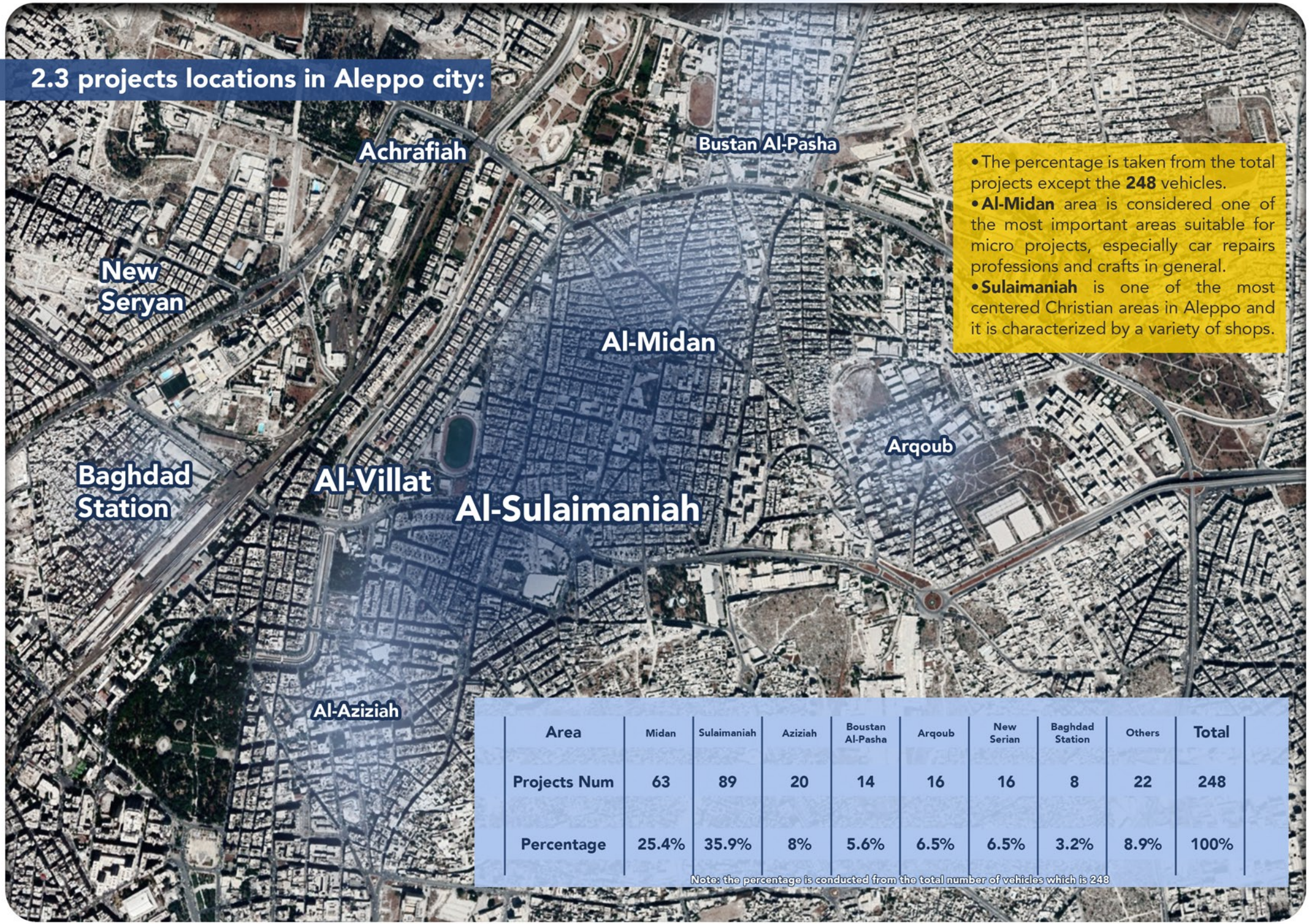


2.2 projects according to beneficiaries group ages:



Note: the number of projects is **349**, but in the chart pie you will find the number **358** which is the number of beneficiaries, the extra **9** number resulted from the partnership of two beneficiaries in **7** projects and **3** beneficiaries in **1** project.

2.3 projects locations in Aleppo city:



- The percentage is taken from the total projects except the **248** vehicles.
- **Al-Midan** area is considered one of the most important areas suitable for micro projects, especially car repairs professions and crafts in general.
- **Sulaimaniah** is one of the most centered Christian areas in Aleppo and it is characterized by a variety of shops.

Area	Midan	Sulaimaniah	Aziziah	Boustan Al-Pasha	Arqoub	New Serian	Baghdad Station	Others	Total
Projects Num	63	89	20	14	16	16	8	22	248
Percentage	25.4%	35.9%	8%	5.6%	6.5%	6.5%	3.2%	8.9%	100%

Note: the percentage is conducted from the total number of vehicles which is 248

2.4 beneficiaries according to their parish:



Note: the number of projects is **349**, but in the chart you will find the number **358** which is the number of beneficiaries, the extra **9** number resulted from the partnership of two beneficiaries in **7** projects and 3 beneficiaries in **1** project.



The following table shows the distribution of the **Christian families** to the parishes in **Aleppo** city:

Armenian catholic	Greek catholic	Syriac catholic	Maronite	Latin
1210	**1800**	**800**	**400**	**500**

Armenian orthodox	Greek orthodox	Syriac orthodox	Chaldean	Evangelic
5500	**2100**	**1100**	**225**	**100**

Total family members

13735

From the previous table, we note the following:

- The largest number of Christian families in Aleppo is Armenian Orthodox, who make up **40%** of the Christian families in Aleppo, but they are not the largest number of funded projects because they have a similar program to support small projects their families.

- The largest number of projects funded are from the Greek Orthodox and Catholic communities because the number of their families represents the largest number after the Armenian Orthodox community, which constitutes about **30%** of the total number of Christian families in Aleppo.

2.5 Projects according to their donor:

caritas POLAND

249
Project

L'Œuvre d'Orient
depuis 1856
au service des chrétiens d'Orient

34
Project

kerk in actie

8
Project

OpenDoors

58
Project





3.

3.1 Monitoring and Evaluation mechanism:

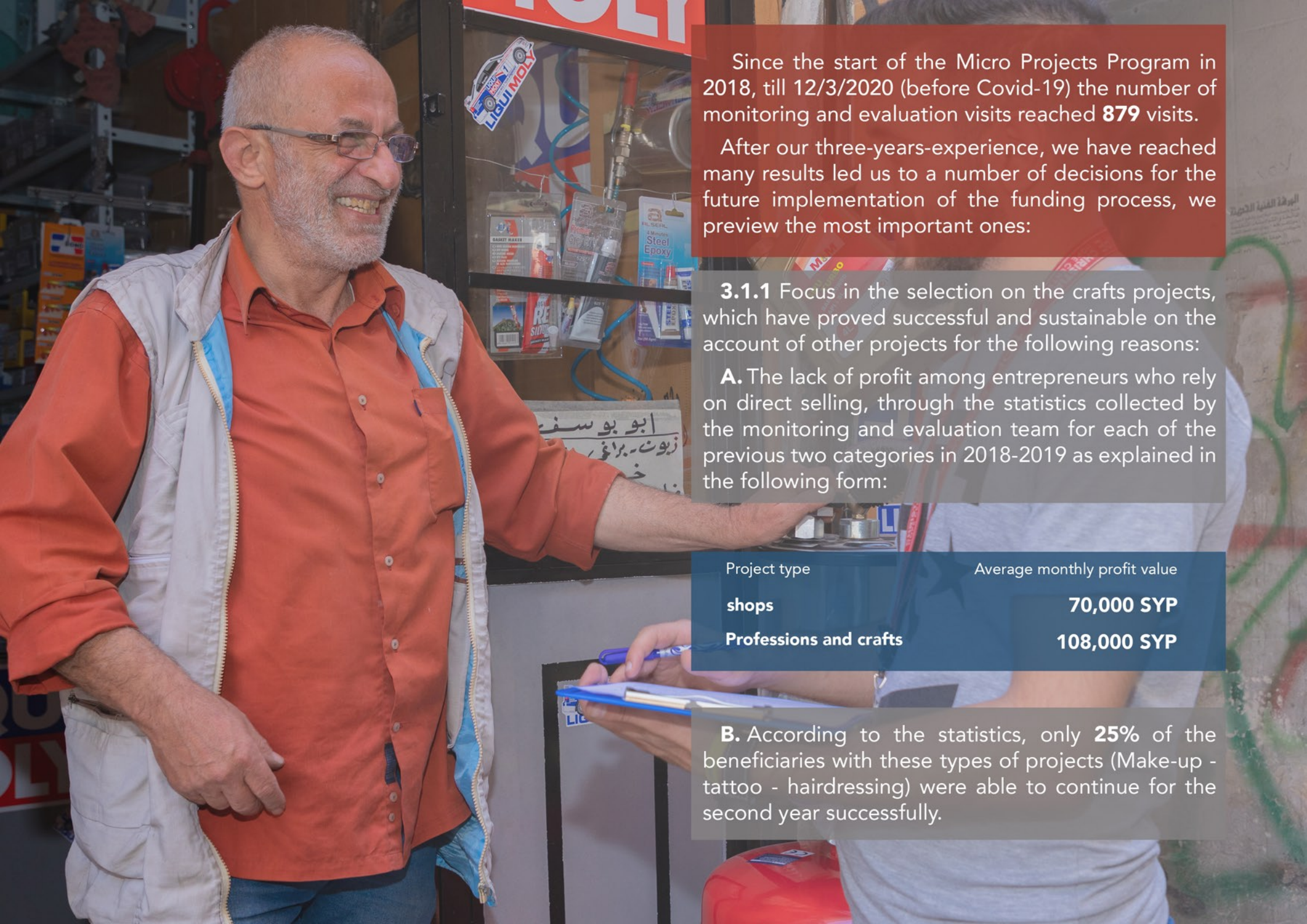
In the normal case, periodic visits are distributed by a specified number according to the lifetime of the project until the end of the refund percentage of the installments

Each project has 3 different types of visits: (view attached Index files to see the questions for the three visits).

- **Index 1.1 /Index 2.1 /Index 3.1 Opening visit:** it is the first visit immediately after the funding, where the beneficiary is asked about all stages of his procedure with the center from reception to the end of the procurement phase, in addition to making sure that he got all the necessary supplies to start the project.

- **Index 1.2 / Index 2.2 / Index 3.2 Index 3.3 Regular visits:** it is a visit where we can measure the factors affecting the project through an evaluation mark developed for each project.

- **Index 1.3 / Index 2.3 / Index 3.4 Closing visit:** Includes the impact the project has had on the life of the beneficiary and his future plan, in addition to handing a trophy of thanks for having contributed to financing of additional projects. It should also be noted that the questions of vehicle projects differ from those of other projects because of the different mechanism of action.



Since the start of the Micro Projects Program in 2018, till 12/3/2020 (before Covid-19) the number of monitoring and evaluation visits reached **879** visits.

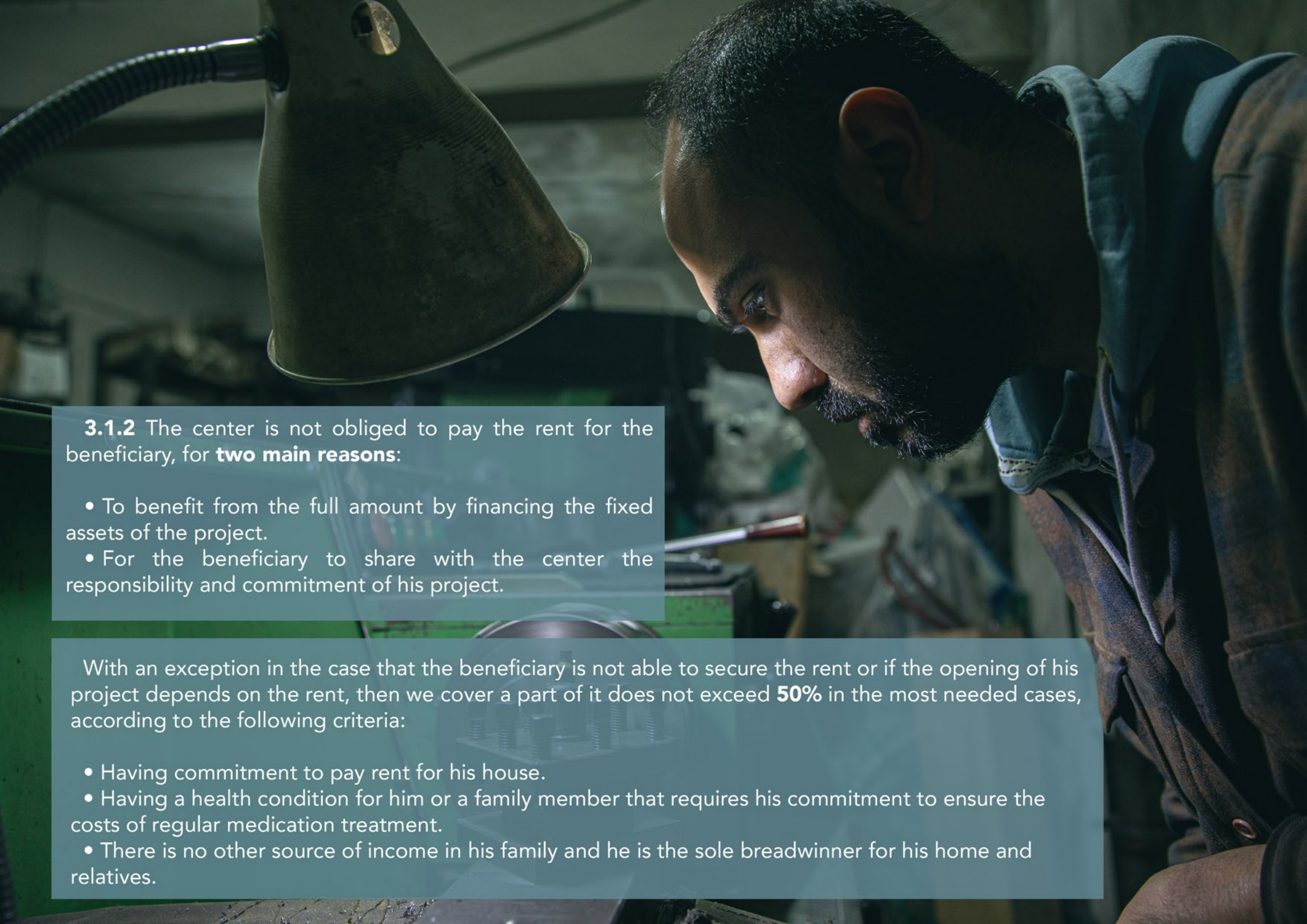
After our three-years-experience, we have reached many results led us to a number of decisions for the future implementation of the funding process, we preview the most important ones:

3.1.1 Focus in the selection on the crafts projects, which have proved successful and sustainable on the account of other projects for the following reasons:

A. The lack of profit among entrepreneurs who rely on direct selling, through the statistics collected by the monitoring and evaluation team for each of the previous two categories in 2018-2019 as explained in the following form:

Project type	Average monthly profit value
shops	**70,000 SYP**
Professions and crafts	**108,000 SYP**

B. According to the statistics, only **25%** of the beneficiaries with these types of projects (Make-up - tattoo - hairdressing) were able to continue for the second year successfully.



3.1.2 The center is not obliged to pay the rent for the beneficiary, for **two main reasons**:

- To benefit from the full amount by financing the fixed assets of the project.
- For the beneficiary to share with the center the responsibility and commitment of his project.

With an exception in the case that the beneficiary is not able to secure the rent or if the opening of his project depends on the rent, then we cover a part of it does not exceed **50%** in the most needed cases, according to the following criteria:

- Having commitment to pay rent for his house.
- Having a health condition for him or a family member that requires his commitment to ensure the costs of regular medication treatment.
- There is no other source of income in his family and he is the sole breadwinner for his home and relatives.



3.1.3 there is a possibility of funding some projects that depend on the sale of goods (direct sale) can be financed only if it is the only job of the beneficiary.

3.1.4 From the beginning of the year, **90** projects were funded from **1/5/2020** to **31/12/2020** and they were all visited the opening visit at the workplace.

3.2 Calculation of the evaluation mark for each project:

Each project has an evaluation mark to be placed at the end of each M&E visit, conducted from several factors affecting the project, which will be calculated through the data program.
Here's an explanation of the factors that are affecting the projects:

1. **Environmental factors:** location - competing- electricity and water - materials.
2. **Financial factors:** profit - debt - partnership - operating expenses - development in capital.
3. **Social factors:** The secondary obligations of the beneficiary towards the home - family – additional sources of income- a health condition that requires a monthly allowance.
4. **Experience:** The beneficiary has been working in this type of project before

In the following table, you can check the distribution of the marks on the factors:

Distribution of marks	Vehicle Projects	Other Projects
Financial factors	60	50
Environmental factors	20	30
Social factors	7	7
Experience	13	13
Total	100	100

The mark determines the evaluation status of each projects as follows:

Weak	0 to 40
Average	41 to 60
Good	61 to 80
Excellent	81 to 100

Note: Previous figures and numbers were conducted from examining the impact of each factor on the project as a result of the experience we have gained since the beginning of the opening of the center and the study of existing projects status.
Financial factors, for example, occupied the largest part of the total because of their direct impact on projects and the rest of the factors in terms of importance and impact as described in Table **9**, although these ratios are partially adjustable in the future.

3.3 2020 visits results:

As mentioned earlier, the total number of projects is **349** from **2018** to the end of **2020**.

- The number of projects that have completed their payments by the end of **2020** is **61** projects, and they have been handed a trophy for their commitment and contribution to funding additional projects.
- Number of projects visited (opening visit) **37** projects from **1/11/2020** to **31/12/2020.**
- Number of projects closed due to failure is **6** projects.
- Number of remaining projects visited and evaluated is **245**, divided into **166** various projects and **79** vehicles.

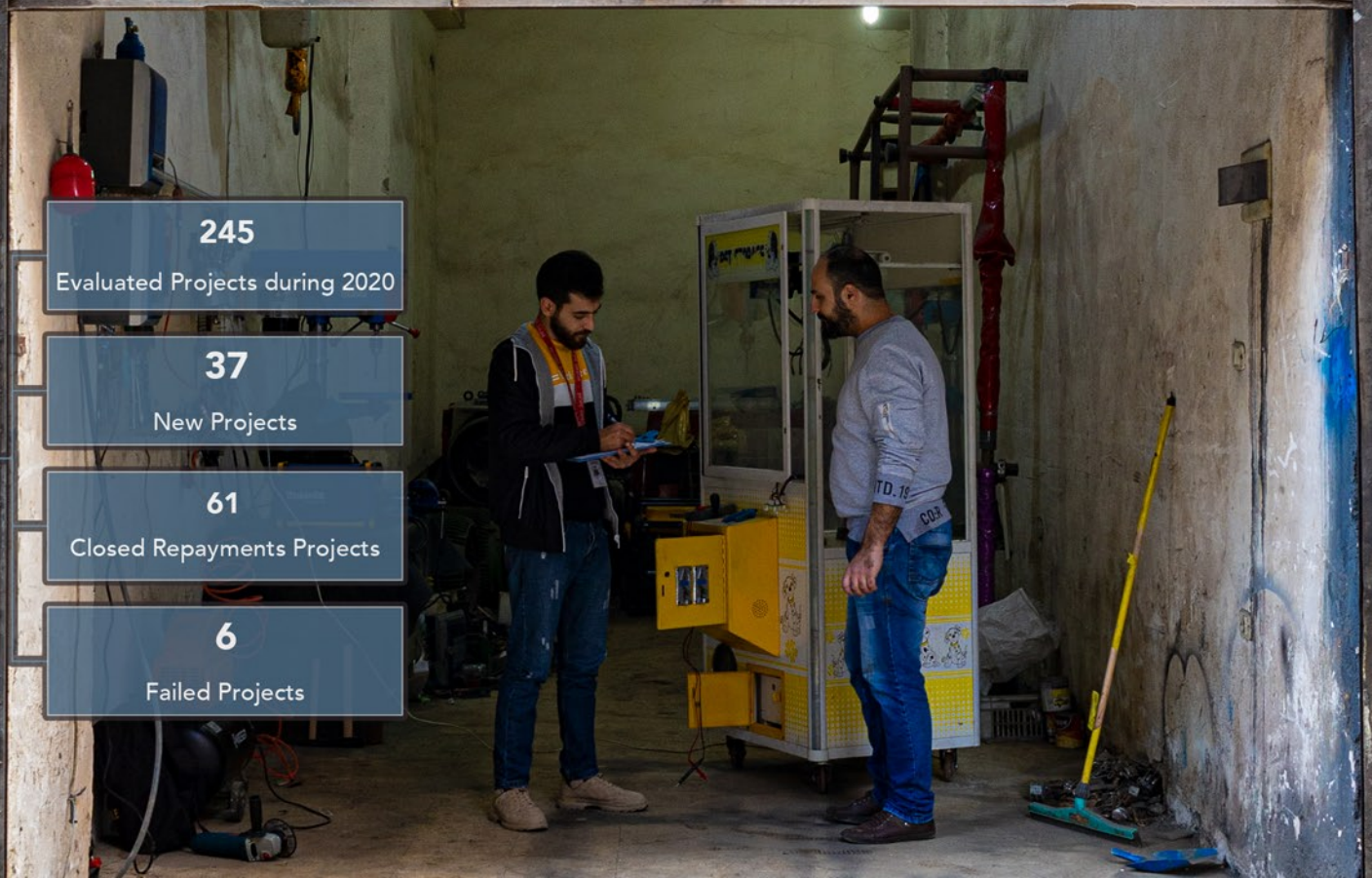
349 Funded Projects

245
Evaluated Projects during 2020

37
New Projects

61
Closed Repayments Projects

6
Failed Projects



3.3.1 vehicles projects:

The vehicles number has reached **79** vehicles currently in the process of monitoring, the results of their evaluation according to the end mark of the affecting factors as follows:



Risks and threats:

One of the biggest problems facing the vehicles projects is the increasing repairs and maintenance especially for the cars of old manufacturing date which reflects negatively on all the affecting factors of project success.

Project mark	status	Number of projects	Percentage from the total number of vehicles
0 - 40	Weak	9	11.4 %
41 - 60	Average	35	44.3 %
61 - 80	Good	33	41.7 %
81 - 100	Excellent	2	2.6 %



Date of manufacture	Funded	Percentage from the total number
< 2004	46	63 %
2004 to 2010	20	25.32 %
> 2010	13	16.45 %

Positive Aspects: the sustainability of work during the current circumstances and COVID-19

Risks and Threats:

1-Mini pickup trucks are facing great difficulty in securing enough work, especially because of closing of many workshops and crafts.

2-The existence of another obligation or debt due to the vehicle: Many beneficiaries resorted to borrowing a second amount to complete the price of the vehicle and obtain the suitable vehicle, which places a heavy burden on the beneficiary.

3-The high prices of vehicles' spare parts, in addition to the maintenance costs which are incoherent to the current pricing of transportation fees.

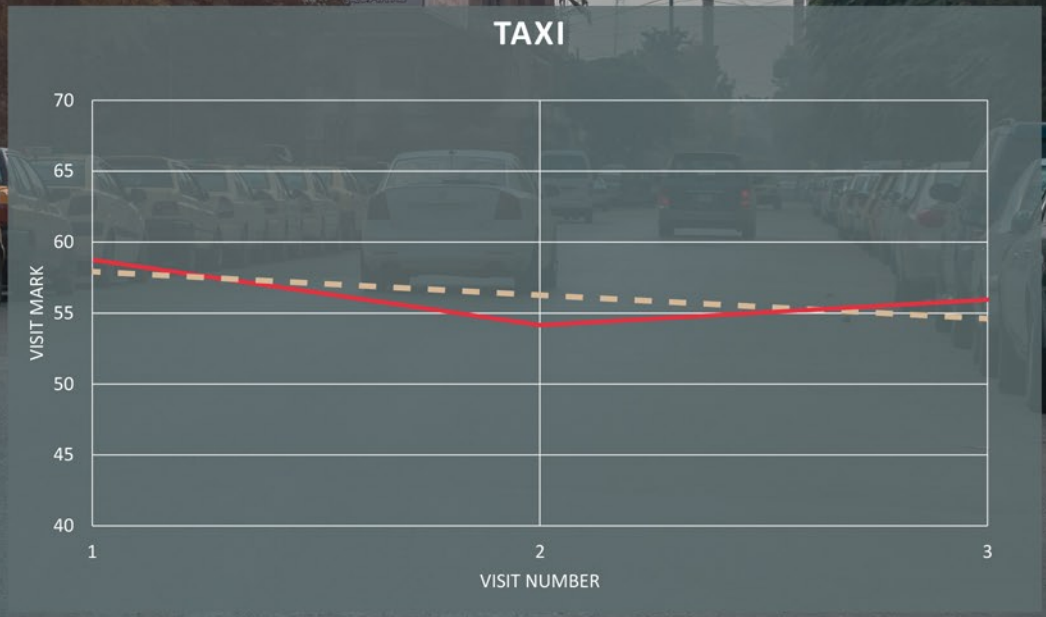
4-The difficulty in obtaining car fuel if it is even available.

3.3.2 By taking the average evaluation result of all vehicles projects:

- We note that the average evaluation of vehicle projects at the corona period have decreased due to the imposed curfews.
- The overall project evaluation dropped about **6** degrees.
- The period after the lockdown was little better, but it's not the same as it used to be, as a result of some factors. Such As:

1. Gasoline crisis
2. The instability of the exchange rate that resulted in the high cost of spare parts.
3. The lack of spare parts for certain types of vehicles due to the economic sanctions on the country.





3.3.3 Other Projects:

According to the project evaluation marks the following shows the ranking of the **166** projects:

Project mark	status	Number of projects	Percentage from the total number of vehicles
0 - 40	Weak	11	6.65 %
41 - 60	Average	61	36.75 %
61 - 80	Good	80	48.2 %
81 - 100	Excellent	14	8.44 %



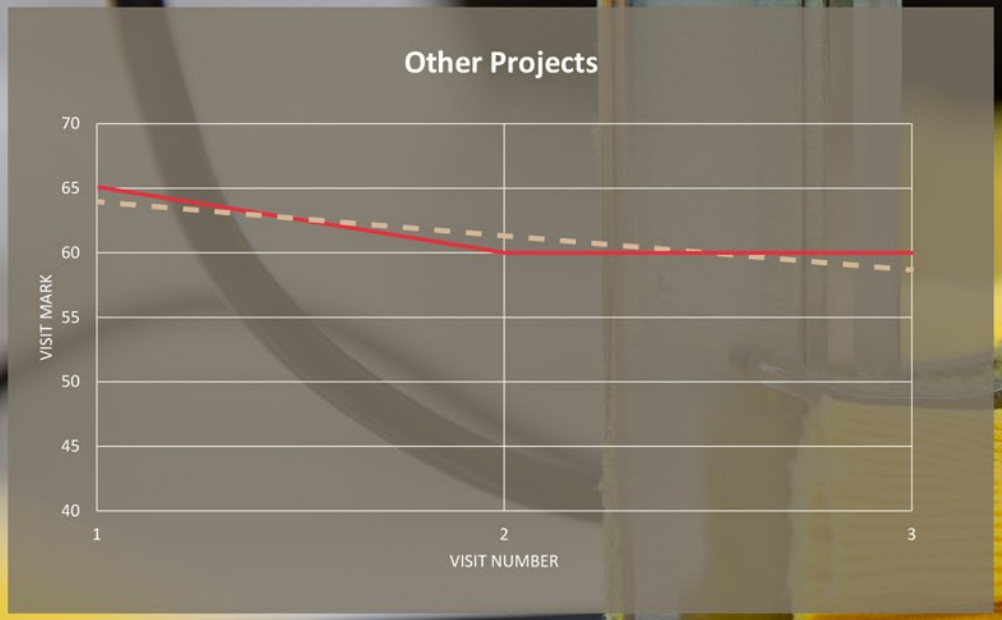
Risks and Threats:

1- Work capacity has been reduced by half for the projects due to corona, with the exception of some types of projects (food- markets- basic needs related shops and services).

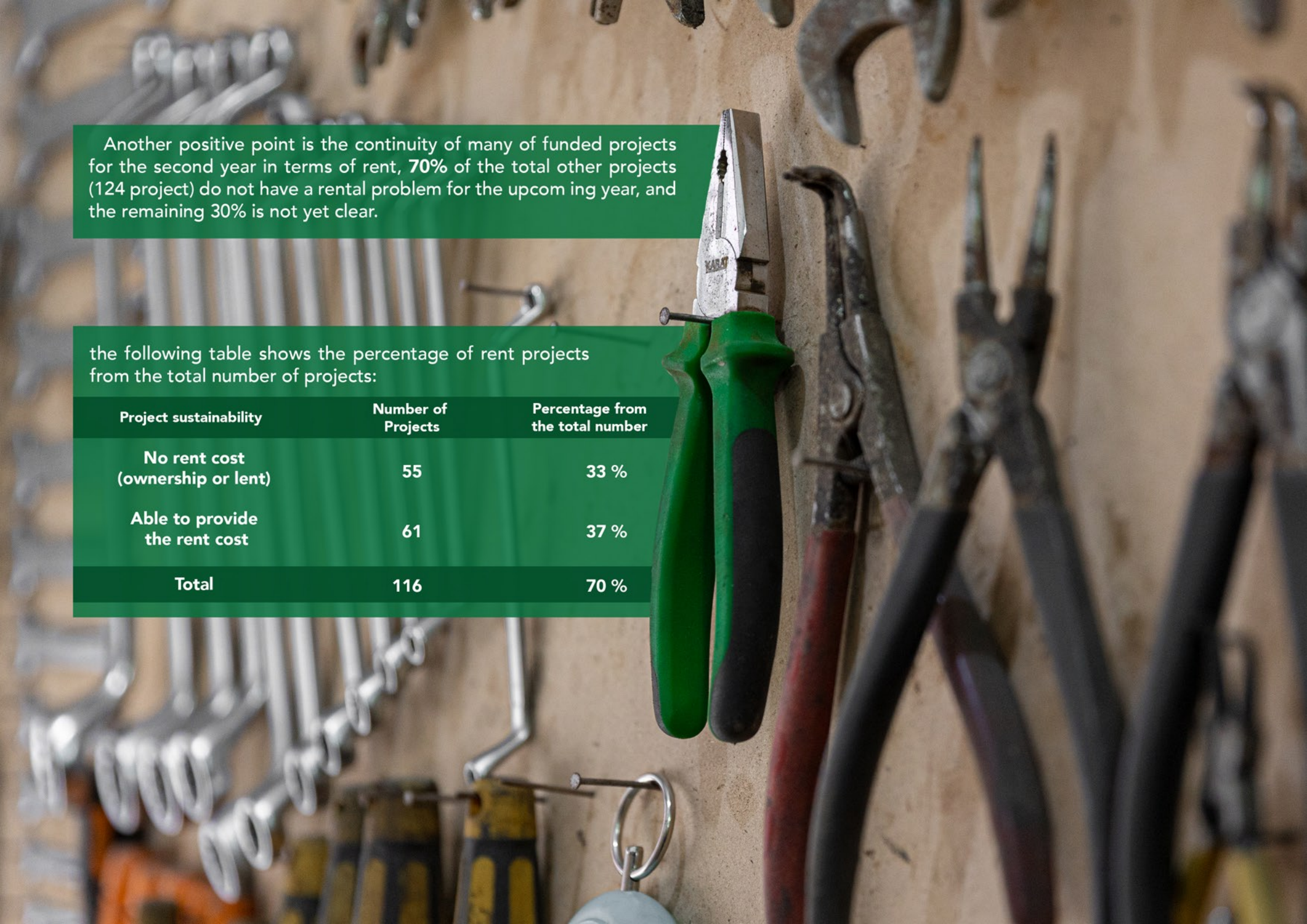
2- The exchange rate increased significantly and rapidly, which reflected on the ability of compensation, especially for projects that guarantee the capital of goods and primary materials.

3- The instability to secure the amount of repayment for most projects due to the current situation of the work market and the lockdowns.

3.3.4 by taking the average evaluation results of visits:



- As for the other project categories, we notice that the average evaluation results decreased during the corona period because of lockdown.
- The project evaluation dropped by about **5** points in comparison to the impact of the lockdown on the vehicles.
- In the period after the lockdown the results of the evaluation did not improve and maintained the decline, this is the difference between the projects of vehicles and the rest of the projects, where the improvement of income for vehicles is on a daily basis and directly related to the improvement of general conditions in the country, as the improvement of the income for the rest of the projects is as extreme due to a lack of services such as (electricity-high rents-change of exchange rate).



Another positive point is the continuity of many of funded projects for the second year in terms of rent, **70%** of the total other projects (124 project) do not have a rental problem for the upcom ing year, and the remaining 30% is not yet clear.

the following table shows the percentage of rent projects from the total number of projects:

Project sustainability	Number of Projects	Percentage from the total number
No rent cost (ownership or lent)	**55**	**33 %**
Able to provide the rent cost	**61**	**37 %**
Total	**116**	**70 %**

4. the impact of COVID19 on projects in the year 2020:

- By taking a sample of **63** existing projects to understand and visualize the impact of the lockdown period in **2020** as a result of the **COVID-19** virus outbreak.

- This number was admitted because the projects visited from January to March (before Corona) in **2020** and took visits to the same projects after the lockdown from June to December **2020**, the number was **63** projects.

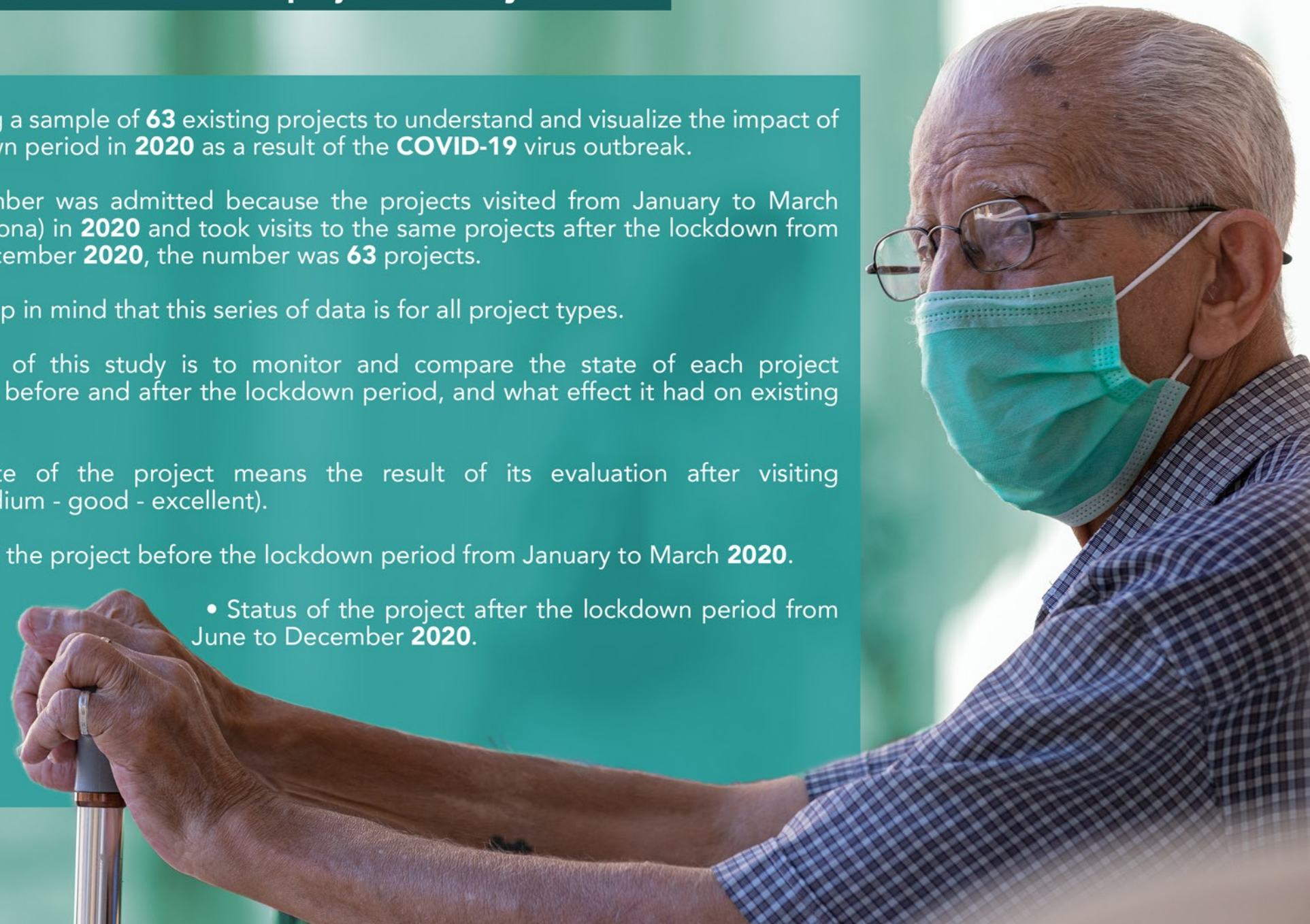
- Let's keep in mind that this series of data is for all project types.

- The aim of this study is to monitor and compare the state of each project individually, before and after the lockdown period, and what effect it had on existing projects.

- The state of the project means the result of its evaluation after visiting (weak - medium - good - excellent).

- Status of the project before the lockdown period from January to March **2020**.

- Status of the project after the lockdown period from June to December **2020**.

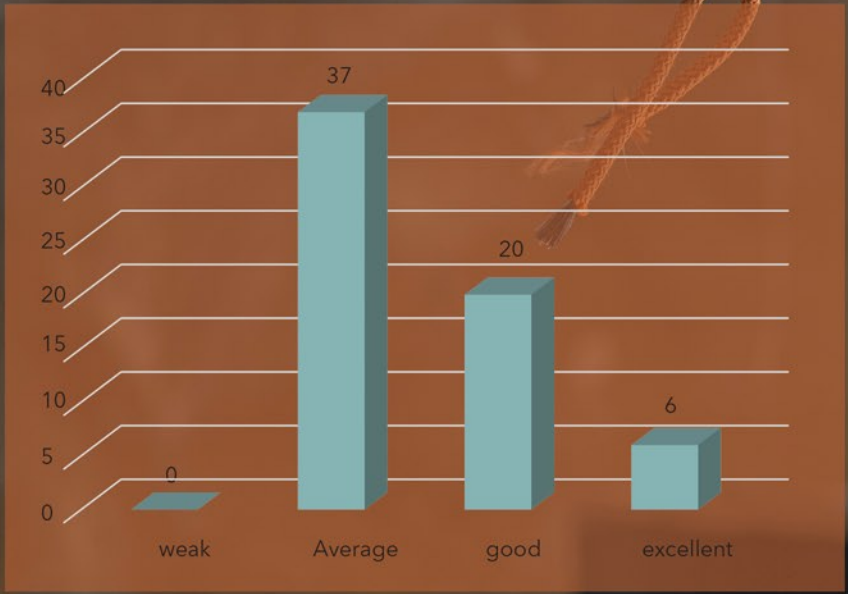


Project Number	Project Type	Before	After
4	taxi	good	average
11	Sewing machine	average	good
21	Supermarket	average	good
30	Coffee shop	excellent	good
39	metal equilibrating laboratory	average	good
42	sewing workshop	average	average
45	taxi	average	average
46	plumbing shop	average	average
55	taxi	good	weak
90	mechanic workshop	average	average
91	fixing cars workshop	average	good
92	barber's shop	average	good
117	plumbing shop	average	good
118	supermarket	good	good
133	iron smithing workshop	good	good
141	taxi	good	average
147	taxi	average	average
151	metal welding workshop	average	weak
176	mini pick-up truck	average	average
197	shoes store	good	average
219	taxi	good	average

Project Number	Project Type	Before	After
228	clothes' accessories workshop	average	weak
230	silver workshop	excellent	good
244	taxi	average	weak
258	carpentry tools	excellent	average
278	aluminum workshop	good	average
283	mini market	average	average
296	paint shop	average	average
305	taxi	average	average
307	espresso shop	good	average
340	nursing kit	average	average
341	beauty center	average	weak
347	packaging and ironing workshop	good	good
376	taxi	average	average
407	taxi	average	average
451	clothes shop	good	average
453	clothes graphic printing	average	good
468	mobile phone maintenance	excellent	good
471	sandwich shop	good	good
507	taxi	good	average
519	taxi	average	weak
541	electrical maintenance shop	good	good

Project Number	Project Type	Before	After
551	taxi	average	average
560	spraying wooden furniture	good	average
565	carpentry workshop	excellent	average
583	Tailoring workshop	average	average
590	sewing workshop	good	average
609	carpentry workshop	good	average
625	Car mechanic workshop	average	average
628	fitness hall	good	good
662	espresso and refreshments shop	average	weak
686	women's sportswear	excellent	excellent
688	electrical spare parts	good	average
696	taxi	average	weak
726	espresso shop	average	weak
727	spraying wooden furniture	average	average
731	taxi	average	weak
734	car repairing	average	average
749	car repairing	average	average
756	taxi	average	average
764	nursing clinic	average	average
786	taxi	good	good
792	sandwich shop	average	average

Before lockdown:



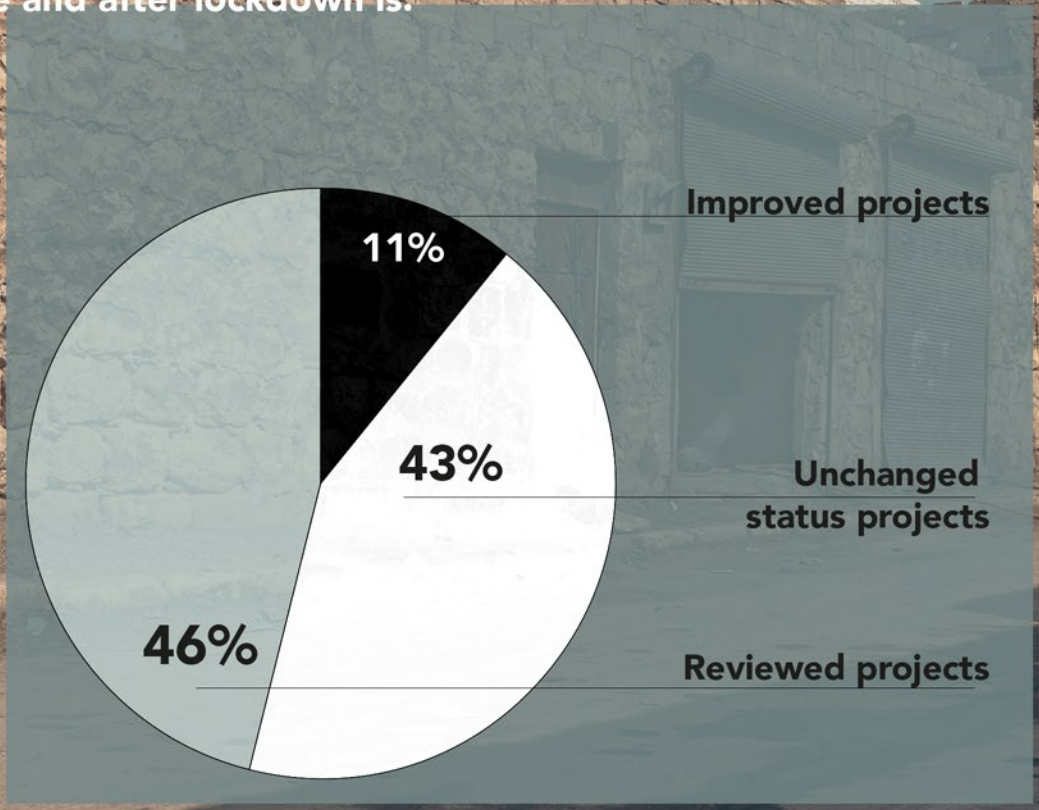
After lockdown:



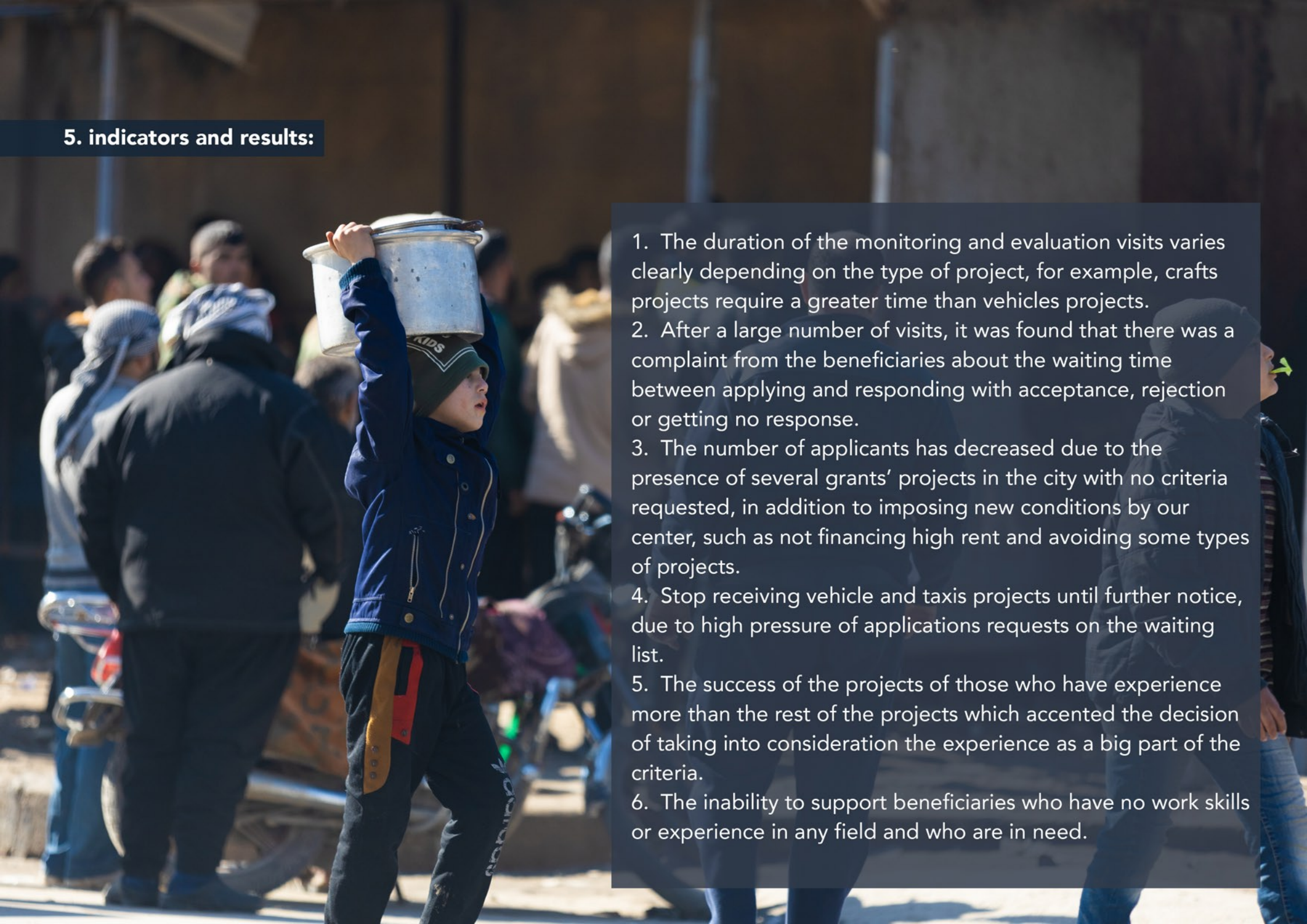
We conclude that from the **63** projects that were studied above:

- **15.9%** of projects were badly affected by the Corona virus.
- **50%** of the previous percentage (projects affected by the lockdown period) are from the taxis and **50%** of the rest of the projects.
- The number of projects reviewed by the evaluation team before and after the lockdown is **27** projects. The number of projects which their evaluation has not changed is 29 projects, in addition to 7 projects that their evaluation has improved.
- **6** of the projects that has improved are from crafts projects such as (sewing machine, car repairing, plumbing, metals crafts...)
- Figures **(12-14)** can be reviewed to have a detailed overlook of the impact on vehicle and other projects separately.

The result of reviewing each project before and after lockdown is:



5. indicators and results:

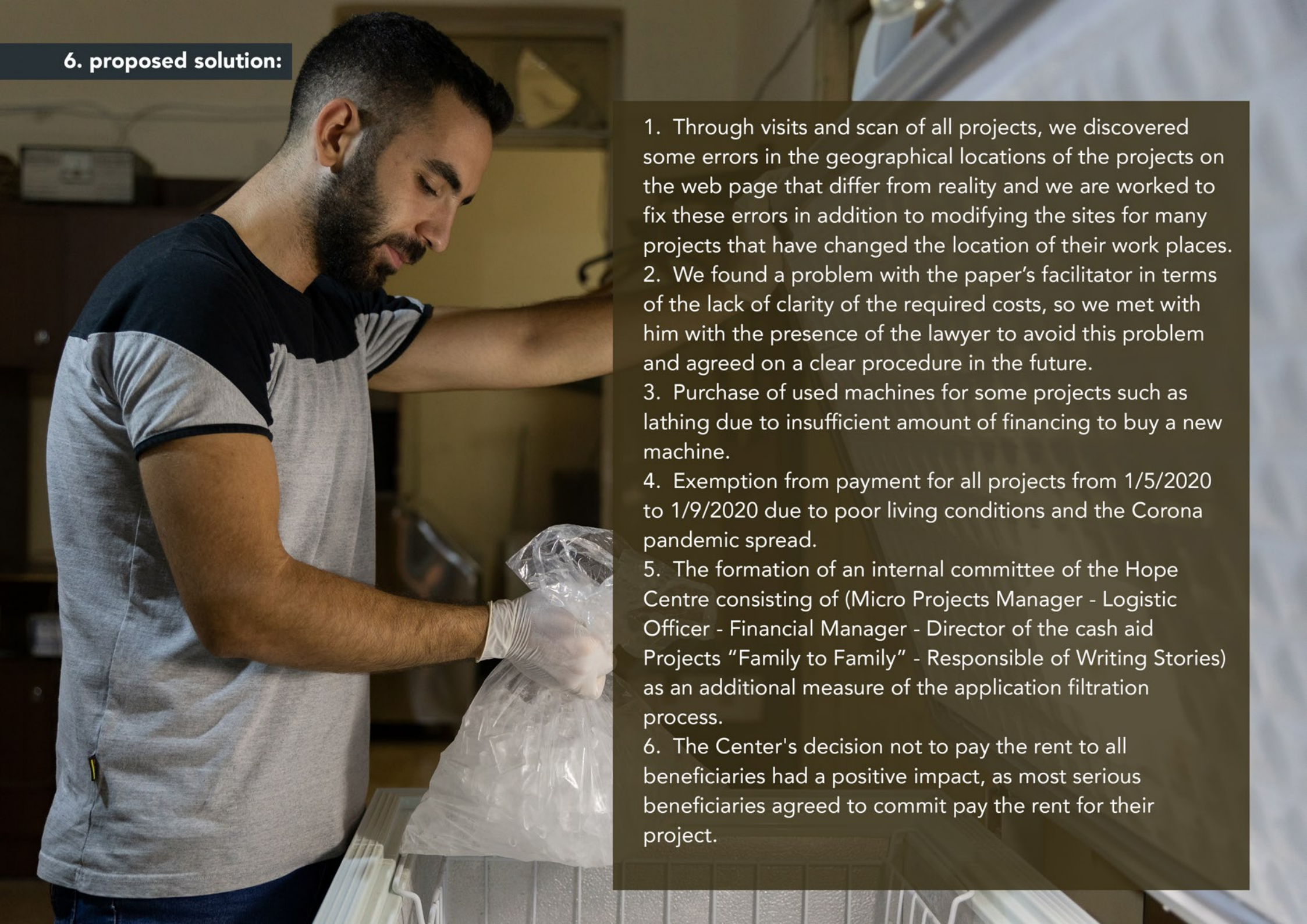


1. The duration of the monitoring and evaluation visits varies clearly depending on the type of project, for example, crafts projects require a greater time than vehicles projects.
2. After a large number of visits, it was found that there was a complaint from the beneficiaries about the waiting time between applying and responding with acceptance, rejection or getting no response.
3. The number of applicants has decreased due to the presence of several grants' projects in the city with no criteria requested, in addition to imposing new conditions by our center, such as not financing high rent and avoiding some types of projects.
4. Stop receiving vehicle and taxis projects until further notice, due to high pressure of applications requests on the waiting list.
5. The success of the projects of those who have experience more than the rest of the projects which accented the decision of taking into consideration the experience as a big part of the criteria.
6. The inability to support beneficiaries who have no work skills or experience in any field and who are in need.



7. Opening projects in new areas after the rehabilitation such as (Ramousa- Sheikh Kheder - Sheikh Najjar).
8. The raise of rental prices significantly and rapidly, which negatively affects the study and success of the project.
9. The inflation of prices of materials which negatively affect the income of the beneficiary to meet his basic needs.
10. Lack of electricity and the cost of alternative electricity (special generators) which is very high thus, affecting the whole work flow.
11. We note that the percentage of funded women from the total projects is 15% because most of the projects submitted by women generally fall into two main sections (sewing workshops - beauty services) because the community culture pushes women in general to go in the direction of these professions. The percentage of women applicants reached 11% from the total applicants' number which is 1411.

6. proposed solution:



1. Through visits and scan of all projects, we discovered some errors in the geographical locations of the projects on the web page that differ from reality and we are worked to fix these errors in addition to modifying the sites for many projects that have changed the location of their work places.
2. We found a problem with the paper's facilitator in terms of the lack of clarity of the required costs, so we met with him with the presence of the lawyer to avoid this problem and agreed on a clear procedure in the future.
3. Purchase of used machines for some projects such as lathing due to insufficient amount of financing to buy a new machine.
4. Exemption from payment for all projects from 1/5/2020 to 1/9/2020 due to poor living conditions and the Corona pandemic spread.
5. The formation of an internal committee of the Hope Centre consisting of (Micro Projects Manager - Logistic Officer - Financial Manager - Director of the cash aid Projects "Family to Family" - Responsible of Writing Stories) as an additional measure of the application filtration process.
6. The Center's decision not to pay the rent to all beneficiaries had a positive impact, as most serious beneficiaries agreed to commit pay the rent for their project.



7. Adding a clause to the contract with the beneficiary which states that if the project failed for a reason related to the beneficiary, it is required to return the amount of its loan (described in the legal document) instead of the purchases provided, after facing several cases of negligence by some beneficiaries and not benefiting from the return of their equipment to the center.
8. Propose the possibility of supporting industrial projects (crafts - car crafts) with a generator to be added to their loan amount because of their great need for an electricity alternative.
9. Supporting the home-run projects (sewing- handmade crafts-beauty) which empowers women beneficiaries and save the rent costs
10. Taking into account the lack of sufficient experience for the discharged soldiers because of their long service during the crisis.
11. Rejected projects are reviewed again and might be funded after consideration that the reasons for rejection are eliminated.


HOPE
Christian Hope Center